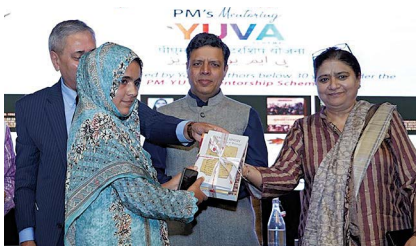
शिक्षा मंत्रालय
भारत सरकार
MINISTRY OF EDUCATION
Government of India

राष्ट्रीय पुस्तक न्यास, भारत
शिक्षा मंत्रालय, भारत सरकार
NATIONAL BOOK TRUST, INDIA
Ministry of Education, Government of India

Chinar Book Festival

in Srinagar Offers New Tools of Expression to the Youth of Kashmir

Chinar tree is an indelible part of Kashmir's history, religion, literature, politics, and romance. The distinct appearances of Chinar, from green to yellow and golden, are seen as a reflection of the changing seasons in Kashmir. Named after this identity of Kashmir, the first edition of the Chinar Book Festival reflects the changing preferences of the Kashmiri youth who are taking up writing as a new means of expressing themselves. In the inaugural edition of the first national level Book Festival, five authors of J&K shortlisted under the PM YUVA mentorship scheme were felicitated in a fully packed SKICC auditorium, Srinagar on 17 August.



Rokaya Rajab from Kupwara is writing her first book under the program in the Kashmiri language titled "Democracy and the Youth", while Ms Shaistah Jan from Baramula is also writing in Kashmiri, a book titled "India: A Dynamic Democracy". Before these girls, three young writers from Jammu & Kashmir had been mentored under the program – Tahir Ahmed Lone (Kashmiri), Bharti Devi (Dogri), and Ekshu Sharma (English). Their first titles have already been published by the National Book Trust India.



Release of 11 Bilingual Books in Kashmiri- English and Dogri- English, published by NBT-India, in compliance with the National Education Policy

Through its diverse literary sessions, workshops, and cultural programmes, the book festival has brought about a positive shift in the orientation of the youth and children, who are learning to communicate more empathetically and clearly, and feeling more connected. With well-crafted workshops on 'Empathy Circle', 'Emotional Intelligence', 'The art of Asking Questions' and engaging activities promoting communication in local languages such as Story Telling and Creative Writing; master trainers at the festival are providing them with new avenues for self-expression, fostering stronger connection to their cultural roots and the wider world through the medium of books and literature.

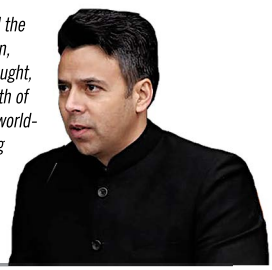
The largest book festival in Jammu & Kashmir since Independence



Spread over 60,000SF at SKICC, Srinagar and with 300 stalls stacked with the world's best publications, on the banks of Dal Lake the Book Festival is captivating the hearts and minds of visitors. Embracing a holistic approach of the Government of India, led by the Ministry of Education, it was brought to life through the collaborative efforts of National Book Trust India, (the nodal agency for the promotion of books and reading culture in India), District administration of Srinagar, National Council for Promotion of Urdu Language(NCPUL), Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO), and Indian Council for Historical Research (ICHR).

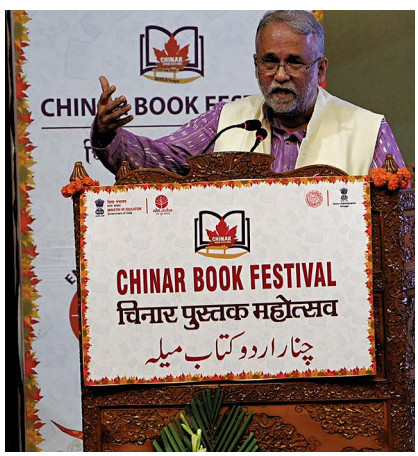
Dr Bilal M. Bhat, IAS and Deputy Commissioner of Srinagar says it is an opportunity for the people of Kashmir to experience, explore and embrace the culture of books and reading.

"In my early days, I visited the Book Fair in Pragati Maidan, New Delhi, and always thought, when the children and youth of Kashmir would also get a world-class book festival, making books easily available and accessible. The festival is a dream come true for me".



Dr Bilal M. Bhat, IAS

Prof Milind S Marathe, Chairman, NBT-India, echoed these sentiments and emphasised that making good books available and accessible in local languages is the government's priority.





National Space Day Exhibition by ISRO showcasing India's stellar space achievements in the field of rocket and communication technology inspires the young ones.